# Casting Rules

Volume 02 — locked in on top of Volume 01. These rules apply to every chapter from April 28, 2006 onward.

## Rule 1 — Real Actors Keep Their Roles

Every MCU character keeps the real-life actor who played them, **except for the twelve roles listed in Rule 2**. They are cast in the story through realistic Hollywood channels: auditions, agents, screen tests, negotiations and press leaks.

## Rule 2 — The Twelve Roles for Fictional Actors

| # | Role | Character (comic-accurate) | Fictional actor (locked) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Iron Man | Tony Stark | Marc-Anthony Bullock |
| 2 | Hulk | Bruce Banner / Hulk | Amond Baker |
| 3 | Captain America | Steve Rogers | Tyrese Avery |
| 4 | Ant-Man | Hank Pym *(founding Avenger)* | David Tipton |
| 5 | Wasp | Janet van Dyne *(founding Avenger)* | Elxa Bullock |
| 6 | Black Widow | Natasha Romanoff | Harmony Divine |
| 7 | Thor | **Thor, daughter of Odin — always female** | Esther Smilley |
| 8 | Hawkeye | **Claire Barton — always female** | Arianna Cummings |
| 9 | Scarlet Witch | Wanda Maximoff | Grace Bullock |
| 10 | Pepper Potts | Virginia "Pepper" Potts | Tayia Boyd |
| 11 | Bucky Barnes | James Buchanan "Bucky" Barnes / Winter Soldier | Tyler Chapman |
| 12 | Quicksilver | Pietro Maximoff | Elijah Blackman |

## Rule 3 — Thor and Hawkeye Have Always Been Women

- **No legacy and no passing the torch.** Thor has always been Odin's daughter, and Hawkeye has always been Claire Barton. There was never a male version.
- **Everything else stays comic-accurate.** Thor is the God of Thunder, Loki is her adopted brother, she is worthy of Mjolnir, and she has full godly power with no nerfs. Claire Barton's history follows Clint's from the comics: the carnival, Trick Shot and the Swordsman, her start as a reformed criminal, and joining the Avengers in *Avengers* #16 (1965).
- **In the real-world story,** this is a creative decision Marvel Studios makes. Trade press, fans and message boards react to it the way they really would have in 2006 and 2007.

## Rule 4 — Ages and Availability of Real Actors

Real actors are cast at a believable moment in their real careers, with their real ages. Ages on April 28, 2006:

| Actor | MCU role | Born | Age (4/28/06) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Samuel L. Jackson | Nick Fury | Dec 21, 1948 | 57 |
| Anthony Hopkins | Odin | Dec 31, 1937 | 68 |
| Jeff Bridges | Obadiah Stane | Dec 4, 1949 | 56 |
| Hugo Weaving | Red Skull | Apr 4, 1960 | 46 |

| Actor | MCU role | Born | Age (4/28/06) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Clark Gregg | Phil Coulson | Apr 2, 1962 | 44 |
| Josh Brolin | Thanos | Feb 12, 1968 | 38 |
| Paul Bettany | Vision | May 27, 1971 | 34 |
| Chadwick Boseman | Black Panther | Nov 29, 1976 | 29 |
| Benedict Cumberbatch | Doctor Strange | July 19, 1976 | 29 |
| Anthony Mackie | Falcon | Sept 23, 1978 | 27 |
| Chris Pratt | Star-Lord | June 21, 1979 | 26 |
| Tom Hiddleston | Loki | Feb 9, 1981 | 25 |
| Hayley Atwell | Peggy Carter | Apr 5, 1982 | 24 |
| Tom Holland | Spider-Man | June 1, 1996 | 9 |

A sample, not the full list. Every real actor gets added to the age register the first time they appear.

## Confirmed Decisions

You answered these on Volume 02's open questions. They are now locked canon.

| # | Topic | Locked decision |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Thor's name | **Thor**, daughter of Odin and Frigga. Her formal Asgardian name is "Thor Odinsdottir." |
| 2 | Ant-Man and Wasp | **Hank Pym and Janet van Dyne**, founding Avengers from *Avengers* #1 (1963), both played by fictional actors. Scott Lang comes later as the second Ant-Man, played by his real actor, Paul Rudd. |
| 3 | Roles with more than one real actor | The actor most identified with the role: **Josh Brolin** as Thanos and **William Hurt** as Thunderbolt Ross. Howard Stark keeps both actors, **Dominic Cooper** when young and **John Slattery** when older. |
| 3a | **Exception: Rhodey** | Rhodey keeps his **real casting history**. **Terrence Howard** (born March 11, 1969; 37 today) plays him in *Iron Man*. **Don Cheadle** (born November 29, 1964; 41 today) replaces him from *Iron Man 2* on. The recast plays out in the real-world story as it did in real life: contract talks, trade headlines and fan reaction. |
| 4 | Characters never played in the MCU | Keep the actor most identified with the role, for example **Hugh Jackman** as Wolverine. |
| 5 | Real-life tragedies | Real history stays the same. Events like Chadwick Boseman's death in August 2020 will happen, and I'll handle them respectfully, the way real life did. |
| 6 | Claire Barton's relationships | Still open. We'll decide when Hawkeye's storyline reaches that point. |